Errata for *Persuasion in Parallel*

Twelve errata in *Persuasion in Parallel: How Information Changes Minds about Politics* (University of Chicago Press, 2022), https://doi.org/10.7208/chicago/9780226821832.001.0001. It also carries three entries of a second kind, which quote a passage and propose no change to it: one slope, one standard error, and one summary sentence that the reanalysis does not reproduce exactly and that no corrected token can repair without writing the author's sentence for him. **No correction and no note here changes a conclusion the book draws.** Every corrected value below is computed at render time rather than typed: four of the first five from the maintained reanalysis in `active-maintenance-aec/coppock_2022`, and entry 1 from the book's own printed tables, held in that repository's transcription of them. Entries 6 to 12 are corrections to the reference list and to citations in the text, found by checking every entry in the list against its published record.

Provenance. Entries 1 to 5 were checked against the printed edition. The reanalysis itself reads an uncorrected proof dated 26 May 2022, so each quoted sentence was verified against the published book rather than taken from that file. Entries 6 to 12 were read from that proof alone, so any of them may have been put right before the book went to press. Entries 13 to 15 quote the same proof, and nothing here records a check of them against the printed edition.

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1. Four sentences in chapter 6 report persistence figures that the chapter's own tables print differently.

Every persistence figure in chapter 6 comes from a bootstrap the deposited code runs without a seed, so no rerun can settle what these sentences should say. The tables can, and each corrected figure below is the number the book's own table 6.2 or table 6.3 prints for the same quantity. The tables are also the side the estimator supports: run at 20 seeds, all five of the figures the tables print fall inside the range their quantity takes across seeds, and none of the five figures the prose gives does.

Page 114.

> Across all 12 studies, the average persistence ratio was about one-third, or 34 percent; that figure is 50 percent in the stronger persistence group and **20** percent in the weaker persistence group (see table 6.2).

Corrected:

> Across all 12 studies, the average persistence ratio was about one-third, or 34 percent; that figure is 50 percent in the stronger persistence group and **21** percent in the weaker persistence group (see table 6.2).

Page 117.

> After ten days treatment effects decay to **46** percent (SE = 5 percent) of their original magnitudes.

Corrected:

> After ten days treatment effects decay to **48** percent (SE = 5 percent) of their original magnitudes.
>
> After thirty days, average persistence declines to **44** percent (SE = 6 percent).

Corrected:

> After thirty days, average persistence declines to **46** percent (SE = 6 percent).

Page 118.

> For Republicans, persistence after ten days averaged **57** percent; this figure was **43** percent for Democrats.

Corrected:

> For Republicans, persistence after ten days averaged **53** percent; this figure was **48** percent for Democrats.

The page 118 sentence is the one that moves furthest, and the two halves fail differently. Its 57 percent is table 6.3's Republican estimate after *thirty* days, read one column across from the ten-day estimate the sentence describes; its 43 percent is no cell of the table at all. The sentence that follows, that the Republican and Democratic estimates are not statistically significantly different, is unaffected and holds on the corrected figures, which are closer together than the published pair. The standard errors on page 117 are left as printed. The ten-day one agrees with table 6.3; the thirty-day one says 6 percent where the table prints 0.05, but the reanalysis returns 6 percent as well, so that figure sits inside the bootstrap's noise in a way none of the five estimates above does. Tables 6.2 and 6.3 are otherwise correct as printed and are not reprinted here.

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2. In the lower half of table 2.3, the difference between the two convincingness ratings for proponents does not equal the difference between the two cells printed above it.

The table prints 3.4 for the pro-capital punishment study and 0.1 for the anti-capital punishment study, and gives their difference as **3.0**. The difference is **3.3**. The changed artifact is that single cell; every other cell in both halves of the table reproduces.

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3. Page 101 gives a standard error that disagrees with the book's own appendix table A.5.

> As shown in the left facet, the average effect of the two-sided message on support for capital punishment is very close to zero for both proponents (0.28 scale points, SE: 0.18) and opponents (0.10, SE: **0.11**).

Corrected:

> As shown in the left facet, the average effect of the two-sided message on support for capital punishment is very close to zero for both proponents (0.28 scale points, SE: 0.18) and opponents (0.10, SE: **0.12**).

Table A.5 reports 0.12 for this same standard error, and the reanalysis reproduces the appendix. The other seven quantities in the passage are correct as printed.

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4. In table 2.2 (p. 26), the two study rows carry each other's labels, in both panels.

Change in attitudes toward the death penalty

	Proponents	Opponents
After **pro**-capital punishment study	0.0	-2.3
After **anti**-capital punishment study	2.7	-0.4

Change in beliefs in deterrent efficacy

	Proponents	Opponents
After **pro**-capital punishment study	-0.7	-2.7
After **anti**-capital punishment study	2.8	-0.2

Corrected:

Change in attitudes toward the death penalty

	Proponents	Opponents
After **anti**-capital punishment study	0.0	-2.3
After **pro**-capital punishment study	2.7	-0.4

Change in beliefs in deterrent efficacy

	Proponents	Opponents
After **anti**-capital punishment study	-0.7	-2.7
After **pro**-capital punishment study	2.8	-0.2

The changed artifact is the two labels alone. Every value is correct, and the rows are in the order the analysis produces them, whose study-content factor runs con before pro and so puts the anti-capital punishment study first. Figure 2.2, printed on the same page from the same variable, shows the con study at 0.0 for proponents and -2.3 for opponents and the pro study at 2.7 and -0.4, which is the table's two rows the other way up. The sentence beneath the figure, reporting that self-assessed change is higher in the pro condition than in the null and higher in the null than in the con, says the same thing again. The "Combined" rows are sums of the two and are unaffected, as is the reading of the table that the surrounding text draws from them.

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5. Page 114 attributes a persistence estimate to a sample that is not in the persistence analysis.

> Curiously, the different replications of the Hiscox (2006) "expert" treatment generated very different persistence estimates: 49 percent on MTurk but 0 percent on **Lucid**.

Corrected:

> Curiously, the different replications of the Hiscox (2006) "expert" treatment generated very different persistence estimates: 49 percent on MTurk but 0 percent on **GfK**.

Table 6.1 lists twelve panel survey experiments and none of them is fielded on Lucid; the Hiscox rows of table 6.4 are Mechanical Turk and GfK, and table 6.4 gives the zero to GfK. The two percentages are left at the whole numbers the sentence uses because they come from a bootstrap the analysis runs without a seed, and a decimal place would state a precision the estimator does not have.

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6. A misspelled surname (p. 42)

> Fishbein and **Azjen** argue

Corrected:

> Fishbein and **Ajzen** argue

The same paragraph spells the name correctly twice, and so does the reference list.

7. An author's middle initial, in Lord, Ross, and Lepper (1979) (p. 196, refs)

> Lord, Charles **S.**, L. Ross, and M. Lepper. 1979.

Corrected:

> Lord, Charles **G.**, L. Ross, and M. Lepper. 1979.

The first author is Charles G. Lord (doi 10.1037/0022-3514.37.11.2098).

8. A first page, in Nyhan, Porter, Reifler, and Wood (2019) (p. 198, refs)

> Political Behavior 42: **936**–60.

Corrected:

> Political Behavior 42: **939**–60.

The article runs from 939 to 960 (doi 10.1007/s11109-019-09528-x).

9. A working-paper title, in Blair, Coppock, and Moor (2020) (p. 190, refs)

> "When to Worry about Sensitivity Bias: **Evidence** from 30 Years of List Experiments."

Corrected:

> "When to Worry about Sensitivity Bias: **A Social Reference Theory and Evidence** from 30 Years of List Experiments."

The entry gives the article's volume and pages but the title of an earlier draft (doi 10.1017/S0003055420000374).

10. A working-paper title, in Green, Wilke, and Cooper (2020) (p. 194, refs)

> "Countering Violence against Women **at Scale**: A Mass Media Experiment in Rural Uganda."

Corrected:

> "Countering Violence against Women **by Encouraging Disclosure**: A Mass Media Experiment in Rural Uganda."

The entry gives the article's volume and pages but the title of an earlier draft (doi 10.1177/0010414020912275).

11. A citation year in three study tables and a figure (tables on pp. 67, 112, and 119, and Figure 6.1 on p. 115)

> Guess and Coppock (**2018**)

Corrected:

> Guess and Coppock (**2020**)

The reference list has Guess and Coppock 2020 and no 2018 entry, and the other 18 citations of the article in the book give 2020.

12. A citation year (p. 127)

> Little, Schnakenberg, and Turner (**2020**)

Corrected:

> Little, Schnakenberg, and Turner (**2021**)

The reference list dates the article 2021.

Carried, and not corrected

The three entries below are different in kind from the twelve corrections above. Each quotes a passage this edition reprints exactly as the proof prints it, and proposes no change to it. In each, the reanalysis disagrees with the page by a little, or the sentence says less than it needs to, and what would replace it is the author's to decide: an estimator that cannot be recovered from the deposit, a sample the sentence does not name, a slope the page may have rounded from elsewhere. Each is recorded here because an edition that silently reproduced them would leave a reader unable to tell a faithful reprint from an uncorrected error.

13. The Democratic slope in the gay marriage series is given as 2.1 points per year where the reanalysis returns a slightly smaller one. (p. 11)

> The slopes for some groups are slightly larger (Democrats **2.1** points per year, White mainline Protestants 2.1 points per year) than for others (Republicans 1.2 points per year, White evangelical Protestants 1.2 points per year), but the overall pattern is very similar from one subgroup to the next.

The reanalysis of figure 1.4 returns 2.02 points per year for Democrats, which prints 2.0, where the sentence says 2.1. The other three slopes the sentence names reproduce: 2.09 for White mainline Protestants, which rounds to the printed 2.1, and the two it gives as 1.2. No corrected token is set because the discrepancy is one tenth of a point in a sentence whose point is that the slopes are similar, and the deposit does not say whether the page rounded another figure or took the slope from a different specification, so any replacement would be a guess at the author's number. A reader who quotes the sentence is not misled about the pattern it describes. No conclusion of the book changes: the slopes remain similar from one subgroup to the next, and the sentence's own comparison of larger and smaller slopes stands.

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14. A standard error for Republican policy professionals is given as 0.25 where the house estimator returns one that prints 0.24. (p. 8)

> A similar pattern holds for the policy professionals: 0.52 (**0.25**) for Republicans and 0.29 (0.20) for Democrats.

The maintained reanalysis uses the HC2 variance estimator and returns 0.24453 for this standard error, which prints 0.24 against the published 0.25. The HC3 estimator returns 0.24589, which prints 0.25, and HC3 reproduces all eight of the chapter's standard errors where HC2 reproduces seven. The deposit contains no code for any of the eight, so the estimator behind the published figure cannot be established, and the rewrite keeps the house default and does not switch to the one that happens to match. No corrected token is set because which of the two the author used is the open question, and the two differ by 0.001 before rounding. No conclusion of the book changes: the point estimate and the similarity of the pattern between the two parties do not depend on the second decimal of one standard error.

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15. A sentence says three treatments all had persistence ratios above 60 percent, without saying which sample, and the ratio is below 60 percent in one of the four rows they span. (p. 114)

> The pro-minimum wage videos, the flat tax op-ed, and the pro-capital punishment studies **all had persistence ratios above 60 percent**.

The three treatments span four rows of table 6.4, because the flat tax op-ed was fielded on two samples and the sentence names neither. Three of the four clear 60 percent: the flat tax op-ed on Mechanical Turk at 69, the pro-minimum wage videos at 61, and the pro-capital punishment studies at 66. The fourth, the flat tax op-ed among policy professionals, is 39 percent, in the book's own table 6.4 and in the reanalysis. The sentence holds on Mechanical Turk, where all three treatments were run, so what is missing is the name of the sample

and not a number, and naming it is the author's to do. No corrected token is set. No conclusion of the book changes: the chapter's account of persistence rests on the tables, and the sentence is a summary of them that is accurate for the sample it presumably means.